

Play... Play...

Q I have a Sony-Ericsson K700i mobile. I recorded some videos and saved them on my PC via Bluetooth. I can't play the videos—they're in a format called 3GP. What do I do?

Sapna Rajput, via e-mail

A The videos recorded on the Sony-Ericsson K700i are in 3GP format, which is a low-res variation of the MPEG-4 standard. 3GP videos can be played on the PC using a player such as VLC Player from www.videolan.org or Quicktime Player from www.apple.com/quicktime.

Can't Standby

Q I just formatted my system and my 'Standby' option is disabled. There is no option in the Power Management choices in Control Panel either. How do I get this back?

Ashish Namdeo, via e-mail

A You've mentioned that you just formatted your system. The "Standby" option is unavailable when you haven't yet installed the display drivers for your display card or when the display card or drivers of your system do not support power management features.

You will be able to enable the Standby option by installing the latest drivers for your display card from the manufacturer's Web site.

Digitising My Music

Q I have a Sony Discman (NS-700) and I would like to know if there is any way to convert audio cassettes to ATRAC3.

Siddharth Sen, via e-mail

A Sony's ATRAC3 (Adaptive Transformation Acoustic Coding) format is a proprietary audio compression technology similar to MP3, which allows audio to be compressed to a tenth of its original size. You can convert any audio on your computer to the ATRAC3 format.

For this, you first need to install the Sony ATRAC3 Audio Codec from <http://snipurl.com/digitqa2>. You may then use a sound editor such as Sony Foundry to convert the audio cassettes to the ATRAC3. Connect the audio cassette player to the line-in of your sound card using a stereo cable.

Double click the volume control icon in the system tray. Click on 'Options' and then 'Properties'. Select 'Recording' and click 'OK'. Check the box next to Line-in and close the volume control window. These steps will configure Line-In to be the recording source.

POP Goes Gmail

Q I want to get a Gmail account. I want to know how can I get invited and what the SMTP and POP3 settings will be if I want to configure it for use with Outlook Express.

R Kumar, via e-mail

A You no longer need an invite to open a Gmail account. You just have to go to www.google.com/accounts/NewAccount. Once you get a new account, you can use Outlook Express to send and receive mail to and from this account.

First you need to log into your Gmail account and 'Enable POP' access. Now open Outlook Express, click the 'Tools' menu and click on 'Accounts'. First click 'Add' and then 'Mail'. Enter your name in the 'Display Name' field and click 'Next'. Enter your full Gmail address in the e-mail address field and click 'Next'.

Enter "pop.gmail.com" in the 'Incoming mail server' field and "smtp.gmail.com" in the 'Outgoing mail server' field, and click 'Next'. Enter your full Gmail address in the 'Account Name' field and your password in the necessary field. Click 'Finish'.

Now, under 'Accounts', click on pop.gmail.com and click on 'Properties'. Click on 'Advanced' and check the box next to 'This server requires a secure connection (SSL)' under 'Outgoing Mail (SMTP)'.

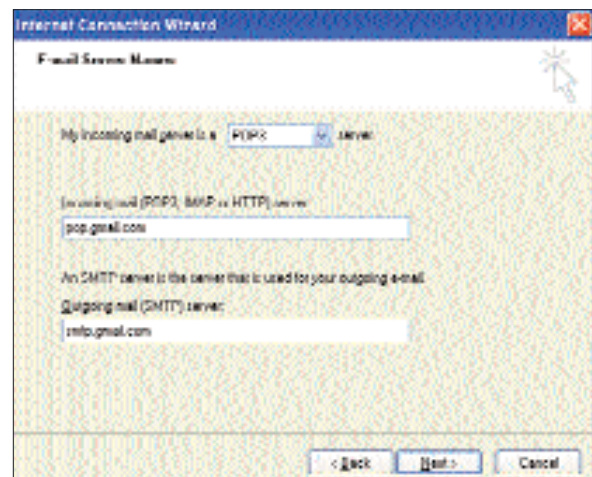
Enter 465 in the Outgoing Mail field. Check the box next to 'This server requires a secure connection (SSL)' under 'Incoming mail (POP3)'. The port will change to 995. Click on the 'Servers' tab and check the box next to 'My server requires authentication.' Click 'OK'. You're all set!

SATA But No DOS?

Q I'm using a SATA HDD with Windows XP, but the problem is that Windows XP cannot go to the MS-DOS prompt. But I need to use DOS because I want to change a system file, which is not possible through Windows. I tried with the start up disk also but it cannot detect the C: drive.

Harikishan A K, via e-mail

A It's not possible to access a SATA drive in DOS mode. You have to do the changes from within Windows. Keep in mind that changing a system file without knowing what the consequences might leave your system unbootable.



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